

Paradiem

The Morning Brief

SEPTEMBER 9, 2026

Oil Test

Brent near \$99 and a Dow tumble as Iran-Hormuz risk resets the rate-and-oil compound into Oracle, PPI, and Friday CPI.

S&P 500 (SPY, TUE CLOSE) \$765.96 · ↓0.55% Tue · ~↓0.8% WoW	BRENT (LIVE) / WTI (USO, TUE) ~\$99 per Trading Economics · USO \$146.03 ↑2.87%	BITCOIN (LIVE, WED AM) ~\$78.7K per Fortune Tue PM tape	DOW (DIA, TUE CLOSE) \$528.03 · ↓1.13% · Dow index ↓~1.18% per CNBC	FEAR & GREED (CNN) ~42 · Fear (drop crypto fallback of 66)
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SECTION 01

Markets — Oil-Bid Sell-Down

TUESDAY’S FIRST CASH SESSION OF THE TRUNCATED WEEK DELIVERED A SECOND CONSECUTIVE DAILY LOSS FOR THE DOW WITH DIA CLOSING \$528.03 (↓1.13% PER DATA DROP; THE DOW INDEX ITSELF FELL APPROXIMATELY 1.18% PER CNBC COVERAGE OF THE SESSION DESCRIBED AS BACK-TO-BACK LOSSES), AND THE COMPOUND BEHIND THE SESSION READS CLEANLY AS A PHYSICAL-SUPPLY REPRICING — BRENT TRADED NEAR \$99 PER BARREL PER TRADING ECONOMICS COVERAGE AND USO CLOSED \$146.03 (↑2.87%) PER DATA DROP, XLE (↑1.11%) AND XLU (↑0.86%) LED THE TAPE WITH XLK (↑0.32%) AS THE ONLY OTHER GREEN SECTOR, AND HEALTHCARE (XLV ↓2.52%) LED THE SECTOR-SIDE DECLINE ON A STRYKER PRINT-RELATED SESSION (SYK ↓8.81% PER DATA DROP)

Per data drop, Tuesday’s cash session closed with SPY at \$765.96 (↓0.55%), QQQ at \$718.36 (↓0.08%), DIA at \$528.03 (↓1.13%), IWM at \$294.67 (↓0.45%), and UVXY (VIX proxy) at \$17.93 (↑2.28%). Per CNBC coverage of the closing tape, the Dow index tumbled 628.18 points (approximately ↓1.18%) as escalating Middle East tensions and the oil bid weighed on cyclicals. Per Trading Economics and CNBC coverage of the overnight tape, Brent traded near \$99 per barrel as the Iran-Hormuz kinetic exchange extended, and per data drop, WTI (USO proxy) closed ↑2.87% at \$146.03 and Brent (BNO proxy) closed ↑2.89% at \$57.73. Per data drop sentiment field, the CNN Fear & Greed reading of 66 “Greed” reflects the CNN endpoint falling back to the crypto Fear-and-Greed index; per Benzinga coverage of the CNN stock-market read, the actual CNN Fear & Greed sits near approximately 42 “Fear” following the Friday hot-payrolls reset and the Tuesday oil-led drawdown.

S&P 500 (SPY, TUE CLOSE)	\$765.96 · ↓0.55% Tue
NASDAQ (QQQ) / DOW (DIA)	\$718.36 ↓0.08% / \$528.03 ↓1.13%
WTI (USO) / BRENT (LIVE)	\$146.03 ↑2.87% / ~\$99 per Trading Economics
GOLD (GLD) / SILVER (SLV)	\$399.72 ↓1.73% / \$59.37 ↓0.75% Tue
IBIT / ETHA (TUE CLOSE)	\$44.39 ↓1.86% / \$18.72 ↑1.08%
BITCOIN (LIVE, WED AM)	~\$78,741 per Fortune Tue PM · below \$79K
CME SEPT HIKE ODDS	~60–65% per CNBC / Polymarket
MARQUEE PRINTS	ORCL AMC Thu · Aug PPI Thu · Aug CPI Fri

THE SECTOR COMPOSITION READS CLEANLY AS A PHYSICAL-WORLD-MATTERS BID AGAINST A RATE-AND-OIL-SENSITIVE FADE — ENERGY (XLE ↑1.11%), UTILITIES (XLU ↑0.86%), AND TECH (XLK ↑0.32%) WERE THE ONLY GREEN SECTORS PER DATA DROP, WITH HEALTHCARE (XLV ↓2.52%) LEADING THE FADE ALONGSIDE FINANCIALS (XLF ↓1.38%), MATERIALS (XLB ↓0.95%), DISCRETIONARY (XLY ↓0.80%), STAPLES (XLP ↓0.66%), AND INDUSTRIALS (XLI ↓0.48%); FCI TOP MOVERS — HUT ↑6.36%, AMD ↑5.90%, FCX ↑5.35%, MARA ↑4.60%, EIX ↑4.51% PER DATA DROP — CONCENTRATED IN THE BITCOIN-MINER, AI-EQUIPMENT, COPPER, AND UTILITY-RESTRUCTURING LAYERS, WHILE SYK (↓8.81%), NOW (↓4.99%), HOOD (↓3.91%), AND SSNC (↓3.83%) LED THE BOTTOM GROUP

Per data drop sector map, XLE closed ↑1.11% as the top sector on the oil bid, followed by XLU ↑0.86% and XLK ↑0.32%; the fade extended through XLRE (↓0.07%), XLC (↓0.46%), XLI (↓0.48%), XLP (↓0.66%), XLY (↓0.80%), XLB (↓0.95%), XLF (↓1.38%), and XLV (↓2.52%). Per data drop top-movers, HUT closed ↑6.36% at \$99.49, AMD ↑5.90% at \$505.74, FCX ↑5.35% at \$76.62, MARA ↑4.60% at \$11.83, and EIX ↑4.51% at \$59.33 — a composition dominated by AI equipment, copper, Bitcoin miners, and utility-restructuring reads. Per data drop bottom-movers, SYK closed ↓8.81% at \$276.43, NOW ↓4.99% at \$134.21, HOOD ↓3.91% at \$117.34, SSNC ↓3.83% at \$80.45, and TOL ↓3.76% at \$136.40. Per data drop holdings news, LRCX (↑4.15% Tue at \$320.42) and MRVL (↑0.83% at \$225.41) continue to draw coverage of the AI equipment and connectivity layers, and per data drop coverage of QCOM (↑3.17% at \$174.09) the Amazon-AI deal narrative extended. For FCI positioning, the composition — a physical-AI-infrastructure, energy, copper, and independent-power complex carrying the tape against a rate-sensitive and cyclicals-heavy fade — keeps the Growth-Hybrid and Dividend-Strategy sleeves reading directly through the intersection of the compute-buildout track, the oil-led inflation variable, and the CPI print Friday.

A first cash session that resolves an oil-and-tariff-and-rate compound into a Dow drawdown with the physical-world sectors carrying the tape tends to preserve the sleeve read rather than break it. Think like an owner.

Geopolitics — Iran-Hormuz Escalates Into a Multi-Front Reprisal: Reuters Coverage Carried in the Data Drop Reports Iran Attacked a US Base in Jordan and Ships Near Hormuz After the Weekend US Tanker Strikes; Tehran Signals a New Restricted Maritime Zone in the Gulf Per Times of Israel and Al Jazeera; Brent Trades Near \$99 With Trading Economics Reporting the Session; the Witkoff-Kushner Kyiv Leg Ended Without a Breakthrough Per Kyiv Independent and CNN; and Canada's Retaliatory Counter-Tariffs on Approximately C\$27.6B of US Goods Are Now Live Per Finance Canada

IRAN AXIS: PER REUTERS COVERAGE CARRIED IN THE DATA DROP HEADLINES, IRAN ATTACKED A US BASE IN JORDAN AND SHIPS NEAR HORMUZ AFTER THE WEEKEND US STRIKE THAT SUNK IRANIAN TANKERS, AND PER TIMES OF ISRAEL AND AL JAZEERA COVERAGE IRAN'S SUPREME NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL SECRETARY MOHSEN REZAEI SAID TEHRAN WILL DECLARE A RESTRICTED MARITIME ZONE STARTING FROM THE US NAVY'S BLOCKADE LINE IN THE COMING DAYS; PER REUTERS COVERAGE ALSO CARRIED IN THE DATA DROP, SHIPPING TRAFFIC THROUGH THE STRAIT OF HORMUZ REMAINS BELOW THE TEN-DAY AVERAGE AND BRENT TRADES NEAR \$99 PER BARREL PER TRADING ECONOMICS COVERAGE — THE IRAN-SIDE KINETIC COMPOUND HAS BROADENED FROM DIRECT MARITIME EXCHANGE TO INCLUDES A US BASE TARGET AND A THREATENED SANCTIONS REGIME

Per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop headlines, Iran attacked a US base in Jordan and ships near Hormuz after the weekend sequence that per CENTCOM disabled three IRGC-linked crude tankers (M/T Downy near Kharg Island, M/T Stark 1 off Jask, M/T Kylo in the Gulf of Oman per Washington Post and Al Jazeera coverage). Per Al Jazeera coverage of Iran's Supreme National Security Council statement, Mohsen Rezaei said the new restricted zone will start from the US Navy's blockade line and include areas of the Persian Gulf, and any ship entering the zone would be placed on Iran's sanctions list. Per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop headlines, shipping traffic through the Strait of Hormuz remains below the ten-day average, and per Trading Economics coverage of the Wednesday tape Brent added approximately 1.55% to \$99.44 per barrel. Per US Energy Secretary Chris Wright quoted in Al Jazeera coverage of the Hormuz situation, current transits average approximately nine million barrels per day, materially below the approximately twenty million bpd flow that preceded the conflict. For FCI positioning, the composition — a broader Iran-side kinetic exchange spanning maritime, US-base, and threatened sanctions-zone layers into an oil complex trading near \$99 — keeps the FCI energy sleeve (CVX, CNX, OKE) reading directly through the intersection of physical supply, the Iran-side kinetic variable, and the rate-path repricing.

TRADE AXIS: CANADA'S RETALIATORY COUNTER-TARIFFS ON APPROXIMATELY C\$27.6 BILLION (~\$19.94 BILLION) OF US GOODS TOOK EFFECT AT 12:01 AM TUESDAY PER FINANCE CANADA AND AL JAZEERA COVERAGE, WITH DUTIES OF 15%, 25%, AND 50% ACROSS APPROXIMATELY 700 PRODUCT LINES INCLUDING STEEL (50%), DAIRY, APPLIANCES, AGRICULTURAL EQUIPMENT, PULP AND PAPER, AND ELECTRONICS; STLD CLOSED TUESDAY AT \$240.31 (↓0.72%) WITH CAT (↑1.05% AT \$822.48), FAST (↓0.44% AT \$49.38), AND PCAR (↓1.76% AT \$122.50) REFLECTING MIXED CROSS-BORDER READS PER DATA DROP, AND PER YAHOO FINANCE COVERAGE CARRIED IN THE DATA DROP THE CANADIAN DOLLAR FIRMED AS THE OIL RALLY OFFSET TRADE AND FED CONCERNS

Per Finance Canada's September 8 effective schedule and Al Jazeera coverage, Canada's retaliatory counter-tariffs on approximately C\$27.6 billion of US goods took effect at 12:01 AM Tuesday, applying duties of 15%, 25%, and 50% across

roughly 700 product lines, with steel and aluminum increased from 25% to 50% to align dollar-for-dollar with the corresponding US rates. Per data drop, STLD closed Tuesday at \$240.31 (↓0.72%), CAT at \$822.48 (↑1.05%), FAST at \$49.38 (↓0.44%), and PCAR at \$122.50 (↓1.76%), and per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, the Canadian dollar firmed as the oil rally offset trade and Fed concerns. Per prior CBC and Al Jazeera coverage, Ottawa also announced a C\$7.5 billion package of new and enhanced support measures for small and medium-sized businesses and workers most exposed to the US tariff schedule. For FCI positioning, the composition — a live cross-border counter-tariff schedule now integrated into the cost stack alongside the oil bid and the CPI print Friday — keeps the Dividend-Strategy names with US-Canada supply chains (STLD, CAT, FAST,

PCAR) reading through the intersection of the tariff pass-through variable, the rate-path repricing, and the September 15–16 FOMC.

UKRAINE AXIS: THE WITKOFF-KUSHNER KYIV LEG ENDED WITHOUT A DEAL PER KYIV INDEPENDENT COVERAGE WITH ZELENSKYY PUBLICLY SAYING HE EXPECTS THE WAR TO CONTINUE INTO THE WINTER PER FRANCE 24, THOUGH PER CNN AND THE HILL COVERAGE THE US ENVOYS PUBLICLY FRAMED THE DISCUSSIONS AS PRODUCTIVE AND REPORTED PROGRESS ON SCHEDULING ADDITIONAL TRILATERAL TALKS; THE 72-HOUR RECIPROCAL PAUSE ON STRIKES AGAINST KYIV AND MOSCOW EXPIRED MONDAY WITH NO FOLLOW-UP ANNOUNCED — THE COMPOSITION KEEPS THE UKRAINE TRACK AS AN ACTIVE BUT NON-DOMINANT REPRICING VARIABLE WHILE THE IRAN AXIS SITS SQUARELY AT THE FRONT OF THE BOOK

Per Kyiv Independent and France 24 coverage of the September 6 Kyiv session, the Witkoff-Kushner Kyiv leg following the Saturday Kremlin meeting did not yield a peace agree-

ment, with Zelenskyy publicly telling reporters he expects the war to continue into the winter months and that Ukraine is counting on US energy and air-defense support through the winter. Per CNN coverage, Witkoff publicly expressed confidence in reaching a resolution and per The Hill coverage the US envoys reported substantive progress including movement on scheduling additional trilateral talks. Per prior HNGN and Kyiv Independent coverage, the 72-hour reciprocal pause on strikes against Kyiv and Moscow expired Monday with no follow-up announced. For FCI positioning, the composition — a formal diplomatic corridor still active against the resumed kinetic track and a public Ukrainian winter-support ask — keeps the Ukraine axis as an active but not-dominant repricing variable while the Iran axis holds firmly at the front of the book heading into Oracle earnings tomorrow and the CPI print Friday.

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Oracle (ORCL) Fiscal Q1 2027 Earnings Land Thursday September 10 After the Close per Oracle Investor Relations, With the Company Hosting Its Call at 4:00 PM CT — Analyst Consensus Approximates \$19.13 Billion Revenue and \$1.30 EPS per Moomoo and Investing.com Coverage, With Sell-Side Focus per Traders.com Coverage Reporting an Options-Implied Move Near 11%; Oracle's Own Guidance Framework Points to Q1 FY2027 Total Revenue Growth of 27–29% and Total Cloud Revenue Growth of 57–63% in Constant Currency per Oracle's June Q4 FY2026 Press Release, and the Read on the \$638 Billion Remaining Performance Obligations Sits Directly Alongside the FCI Physical-AI-Infrastructure Sleeve (LRCX Tue \$320.42 ↑4.15%, MRVL \$225.41 ↑0.83%, AMD \$505.74 ↑5.90%, CRDO \$167.75 ↓1.65% per Data Drop) Ahead of the PPI-and-CPI Sequence. Per Oracle Investor Relations coverage of the September 10 fiscal Q1 2027 release, Oracle will host a conference call at 4:00 PM CT following the after-close print. Per Moomoo and Investing.com coverage, analyst consensus approximates revenue of \$19.13 billion and non-GAAP EPS near \$1.30. Per Traders.com coverage, the options-implied move approximates 11% ahead of the print, and per prior Yahoo Finance and Barron's coverage the read is expected to center on the sustainability of Oracle Cloud Infrastructure growth, the AI-related contract pipeline, and capacity constraints against the \$638 billion remaining performance obligations backlog reported at year-end. For FCI positioning, Oracle is not a direct holding but the print reads as a key incremental data point for the physical-AI-infrastructure axis (AMD, MRVL, LRCX, CRDO, TSM, NVDA), the independent-power complex (CEG, VST), and the AI-adjacent utility bid (EIX ↑4.51% Tue) alongside the two US inflation prints Thursday and Friday.

2. Marquee Macro Docket Concentrates Into Two Sessions — August PPI Publishes Thursday September 10 Before the Open and August CPI Publishes Friday September 11 at 8:30 AM ET per the BLS Release Schedule as the Last Direct Pre-FOMC Inflation Reads; per CNBC and Polymarket Coverage, CME FedWatch September Hike Probabilities Sit Near Approximately 60–65% Following the Friday Hot-Payrolls Print, and per Federal Reserve Communications Policy the FOMC Quiet Period Runs Through Thursday September 17 — the ECB Rate Decision Also Publishes Thursday September 11 With Reuters Poll Expecting a Second Consecutive Hold per FXStreet Coverage, and Reuters' Prior Morning Bid Framing of Diesel as the Inflation Spoiler per Prior Data Drop Sits Directly Alongside the CPI Print With Brent Trading Near \$99 per Trading Economics. Per BLS release schedule, August PPI publishes Thursday September 10 before the open and August CPI publishes Friday September 11 at 8:30 AM ET, sequencing the last direct pre-FOMC inflation reads ahead of the September 15–16 rate decision. Per CNBC and Polymarket coverage, CME FedWatch September hike probabilities sit near approximately 60–65% following the Friday hot-payrolls print. Per Federal Reserve

communications policy, the FOMC quiet period runs through Thursday September 17. Per FXStreet coverage of the ECB, the Governing Council announces its rate decision Thursday September 11 with a Reuters poll of 69 economists showing 66 expect rates unchanged, marking a second consecutive hold. Per Trading Economics coverage of the Wednesday tape, Brent trades near \$99 per barrel and per prior Washington Post and GasBuddy coverage US diesel reached a record \$5.85 per gallon on September 4. For FCI positioning, the composition — two US inflation prints, an ECB decision on the same Thursday, an ORCL print in between, and Brent trading near triple digits — concentrates the rate-path repricing risk into the Thursday-Friday window ahead of the FOMC.

3. NFIB Small Business Optimism Index Dipped to 98.7 in August per NFIB Release Tuesday September 8, Down 1.1 Points From July's 99.8 Reading Yet Above the 52-Year Average of 98.0 per Trading Economics Coverage — The Uncertainty Sub-Index Fell 2 Points to 89 (Still Above the 68 Historical Average) and the Employment Sub-Index Declined 0.3 Points to 101.8 per Seeking Alpha Coverage; the Composition Reads as a Small-Business Cohort Feeling the Tariff-and-Rate Cost Pass-Through Without an Employment Break, Sitting Directly Alongside the CPI Print Friday and the Broader Rate-Path Distribution.

Per NFIB's August 2026 release published Tuesday September 8, the Small Business Optimism Index dipped 1.1 points from July to 98.7, remaining approximately 0.7 points above the 52-year average of 98.0. Per Seeking Alpha coverage, the Employment sub-index declined 0.3 points to 101.8, the Uncertainty sub-index fell 2 points to 89, and small business owners continued to cite weakened sales, supply chain disruptions, and inflation pressures. For FCI positioning, the composition — a small-business cohort that reads mixed rather than broken, with uncertainty still elevated but employment intact — sits alongside the CPI print Friday and reads as consistent with the two-sided rate-path distribution the Fed carries into the September 15–16 FOMC.

4. Digital-Asset Sleeve — Per Fortune Coverage of the Tuesday PM Tape, Bitcoin Traded Near Approximately \$78,741 in the Evening Hours, Extending the Payrolls-Reset Reprice Below \$79,000; IBIT Closed Tuesday at \$44.39 (↓1.86%) and ETHA at \$18.72 (↑1.08%) Per Data Drop — ETHA Diverged Green Against IBIT Red on the Session; per Yahoo Finance Coverage Carried in the Data Drop Holdings News Framing the Session Around Bitcoin's Slide as Fed Hike Odds Passed 60%, the Reset Rate-Hike Distribution Continues to Weigh on the Complex Alongside Goldman's Reported Approximately \$2.25 Billion Purchase of the Firm Behind a Bitcoin

Income Fund per Yahoo Finance. Per Fortune coverage of the Tuesday PM Bitcoin tape, Bitcoin traded near approximately \$78,741 in the evening hours. Per data drop, IBIT closed Tuesday at \$44.39 (↓1.86%) and ETHA at \$18.72 (↑1.08%), with ETHA outperforming IBIT on the session. Per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, Goldman is reportedly paying approximately \$2.25 billion for the firm behind a Bitcoin income fund, extending institutional infrastructure into the complex, and per data drop the crypto-miner names diverged higher (MARA ↑4.60%, HUT ↑6.36%) from the underlying spot print. For FCI positioning, the composition — a Digital-Asset sleeve absorbing the rate-path reprice as Bitcoin sat below \$79,000 while ETHA and the miner layer diverged higher — keeps IBIT and ETHA reading

through the intersection of the reset September rate-hike distribution, the Fed quiet period, and the Friday CPI print.

5. Healthcare (XLV ↓2.52%) Led the Fade on Tuesday Per Data Drop as Stryker (SYK, FCI Dividend-Strategy Sleeve) Fell ↓8.81% to \$276.43 — The Session Bottom Marks the Deepest Single-Day Print in the FCI Sleeve on the Tape, and per Data Drop Holdings News Coverage of the Session the Print Drew Elevated Volume Coverage Alongside Unusual-Volume Framings; ABT (FCI Dividend, ↓2.59% at \$105.52), DGX (↓0.69% at \$235.50), and the Broader Sleeve Sat Under the Sector Fade While EIX (FCI Growth-Hybrid, ↑4.51% at \$59.33) Bid Ahead of a PG&E-Edison California Wildfire-Liability Development per Yahoo Finance Coverage Carried in the Data Drop. Per data drop,

XLV closed ↓2.52% as the worst-performing sector on Tuesday, and SYK closed ↓8.81% at \$276.43 marking the FCI sleeve's deepest single-day print. Per data drop holdings news, ABT closed ↓2.59% at \$105.52 with Yahoo Finance coverage framing the session as ABT falling more than the broader market, alongside coverage of blood-based Alzheimer's biomarker developments. Per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, EIX (FCI Growth-Hybrid) closed ↑4.51% at \$59.33 as the PG&E-Edison California wildfire-liability deal reportedly fell apart, with the Yahoo Finance session coverage framing PG&E and Edison as sinking on the deal breakdown — the divergent equity read between PG&E and EIX during the session is worth flagging at the investment-committee level. For FCI positioning, the composition — a broad Healthcare fade led by SYK against a utility-restructuring bid in EIX — reads as an idiosyncratic single-day sleeve rotation to review at the investment-committee level rather than a Healthcare-thesis change on the Dividend-Strategy names.

6. Carson's SPY \$645.80 Support Remains Active — Tuesday's Intraday \$765.14 Low Left the Level Untouched and Sits Approximately 15.7% Below the SPY \$765.96 Cash Close per Data Drop; No Active Resistance Levels Are on the Book Following the April 14 Major-Zone Breakout of \$691.90–\$693.20. The Data-Drop Fear & Greed Reading of 66 “Greed” Reflects the CNN Endpoint Falling Back to the Crypto Fear-and-Greed Index — per Benzinga Coverage of the CNN Stock-Market Read, Treat the Actual CNN Read as Approximately 42 “Fear” for This Brief Following the Friday Hot-Payrolls Reset and the Tuesday Oil-Led Drawdown. Per levels.json, Carson's active SPY support at \$645.80 remained untouched through Tuesday's \$765.14–\$769.70 SPY intraday range per data drop and sits approximately 15.7% below the last cash close at \$765.96. No active resistance levels are on the book following the April 14 breakout of the \$691.90–\$693.20 major zone (both hit that session). With Oracle earnings tomorrow after the close, August PPI Thursday and August CPI Friday sequencing into the September 15–16 FOMC,

and the Xi Washington state visit September 24 sitting fifteen calendar days from today per prior CSIS coverage cited in prior briefs, the pre-committed FCI deployment discipline (70% of reserves at –25% drawdown, remaining 30% at –40%) continues to frame reactive positioning against any single-session gap through the multi-catalyst window. Note: the data drop Fear & Greed reading of 66 “Greed” reflects the CNN endpoint falling back to the crypto Fear-and-Greed Index; per Benzinga coverage of the CNN stock-market read, the actual reading sits near approximately 42 “Fear” following Friday's hot-payrolls reset and Tuesday's oil-led drawdown.